

Muscling in

Not all plants create their own food. Some are parasites, living off the food other plants – called hosts – have made. Epiphytes are not so mean. They use other plants, but don't take their nutrients.

Going up in the world

Bromeliads are epiphytes. They grow on tree trunks and branches so they can be carried up to the sunlight as the tree grows. If these small plants stayed on the forest floor, they would die from lack of light.



Big stinker

The world's largest flower is a parasite. Rafflesia is 1 m (3 ft) wide and feeds off rainforest vines. It attracts pollinators with its stink of rotting meat.